

# Philipp Hilbert. *Enterprise PM who ships workflow infrastructure, not slide decks.*

*Positioning*, a product manager with ten years owning complex technical workflows end-to-end, built to make automation feel like first-class software engineering.

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## § WHY N8N

n8n is one of the few products where the PM role is genuinely infrastructure work: defining how engineering teams version, promote, and operate mission-critical workflows is closer to platform engineering than feature shipping. The job description names environment separation, Git-based source control, and multi-instance observability as the core surface areas — which is exactly the intersection I have been working at across Rohde & Schwarz, the Federal Employment Agency, and Emil Group. The 190K GitHub stars and the SAP strategic investment together signal that n8n is past proof-of-concept and entering the phase where enterprise-grade reliability is the actual product. *That is precisely the inflection point where structured, technically fluent product ownership compounds fastest.*

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## § AI-NATIVE STACK

*Daily tools, not buzzwords.*

- **Claude**, spec drafting, edge-case generation, code review
- **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder communication
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted development and refactoring
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing and concept validation

- **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and async communication
  - **n8n**, multi-agent orchestration and agentic workflow design
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## § TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

*Shipped with, not just listed.*

Production work spans Kotlin with Spring Boot, Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, and low-code platform runtimes. GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD, CI/CD pipeline standardisation with full test integration at build time, and Kubernetes cluster migrations are part of the delivered record, not aspirational bullet points.

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## § SIDE PROJECT

DEV AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

*A personal agentic orchestration framework built to automate crypto market analysis and backtesting.*

- Implements file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous data ingestion, signal generation, and execution simulation.
  - Architecture draws on n8n-style orchestration logic combined with Python-native tooling for low-latency data handling.
  - Integrates with exchange APIs and on-chain data sources across centralised and decentralised venues.
  - Directly relevant to n8n's enterprise workflows: demonstrates practical understanding of how agentic pipelines fail, recover, and need observability to be operable at scale.
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## § HOW I WOULD WORK AT N8N

*First weeks, concrete.*

### WEEK 1

**Listen, map, find the gaps.**

Shadow enterprise customer calls and solutions engineering handoffs to map where workflow promotion, environment separation, and Git integration break down in practice today.

## WEEK 2

### Slice and prioritise.

Structure discovery findings into a prioritised problem stack – separating quick reliability wins from longer platform bets – and align with engineering leads on feasibility constraints.

## WEEK 3+

### Ship, observe, iterate.

Drive the first concrete spec through refinement and into engineering, instrument it for observability from day one, and establish the feedback loop with enterprise customers that keeps the roadmap honest.

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## *I* COVER LETTER

Dear n8n team,

I have been running n8n workflows for multi-agent orchestration in my own tooling, so this application comes with hands-on context rather than slide-deck familiarity. What drew me to the Enterprise PM role specifically is the nature of the problem: helping engineering teams treat automation with the same rigour as software – versioning, environment promotion, rollback, observability – is infrastructure product work, and that is the territory I know best.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned the product for a central AI and data management platform inside the FCAS defence programme. The core challenge was identical in structure to what n8n faces at enterprise scale: workflows that started as prototypes needed to become auditable, reproducible, and operable by teams who did not build them. I introduced GitOps with ArgoCD and reduced deployment times from several days to twenty minutes. I unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently and delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year. That pattern – close the gap between what engineering can see and what operators need to trust – is directly what the workflow lifecycle management and observability pillars of this role require.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I served as Deputy IT Security Officer while simultaneously advancing the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL, standardised CI/CD with full test integration, and migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes. Working across compliance, governance, data lineage, and feature delivery simultaneously gave me a durable intuition for where enterprise-grade reliability requirements actually originate – they come from the audit trail, the secrets management, the configuration drift, and the absence of rollback, not from a checklist.

At Emil Group, I stepped into a prototype-stage InsurTech environment where sprint discipline had collapsed and client trust was at risk. I split a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking, and rebuilt the delivery rhythm. I also regained client trust through structured communication and weekly product workshops. That experience sharpened my conviction that influence without authority is not a soft skill – it is the operational core of enterprise product management, where engineering, sales, solutions engineering, and customer success all have legitimate claims on prioritisation and none of them report to you.

The n8n Enterprise PM role sits at the exact intersection of developer experience, production operations, and cross-functional alignment that I have been working in across all three of those engagements. I am fluent in Git-based workflows, comfortable making tradeoffs between usability and implementation complexity, and experienced enough with Kubernetes and GitOps to have substantive architecture conversations with engineers rather than just transcribing them. I would be glad to walk through any of the specifics in a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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## II CURRICULUM VITAE

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### § BEARING

Enterprise-focused Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning complex technical workflows from discovery through GitOps-based production rollout. Background spans AI data platforms, public analytics infrastructure, InsurTech SaaS, and mobile healthcare – consistently in environments where requirements are incomplete, stakeholders are technically demanding, and delivery rigour is non-negotiable. Equally comfortable writing acceptance criteria, unblocking an OpenShift deployment independently, and running stakeholder workshops across engineering, compliance, and enterprise customers. Low ego, high agency, and a strong bias for shipping over planning.

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### § CORE STRENGTHS

- Workflow lifecycle management: environment separation, promotion paths, rollback
- GitOps and CI/CD pipeline ownership with ArgoCD, Kubernetes, Jenkins
- Enterprise developer experience and Git-based source control product design
- Production observability, audit trails, and data provenance for regulated environments

- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, design, sales, and customer success
  - Backlog discipline, sprint restructuring, and velocity recovery under delivery pressure
  - Technical fluency sufficient for architecture-level tradeoff discussions
  - Product discovery in ambiguity: risk-first framing across value, feasibility, and viability
  - Founder-level pragmatism: ships, learns, iterates rather than over-plans
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## § PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

### *Product Manager, AI Data Transformation*

- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD across a Kubernetes/OpenShift environment.
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout.
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; sole developer for a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year – delivered in one week.
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible data transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance.
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI).
- Led a cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA.

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

### *Product Manager, Public Data Analytics*

- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time.
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades.
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage.
- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling.
- Designed interactive dashboards and community features for a platform serving regional labour market stakeholders.

## EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

### *Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform*

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, effective Scrum units and introduced ownership and deputy concepts.
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure.
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops.
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout.
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure.

## CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

### *Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App*

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on iOS and Android.
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases.
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows under tight deadlines.

## BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

### *Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform*

- Owned product for RKI projects DIM and DESH: secure data structures and identity management under strict regulatory constraints.

## QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

### *Co-Founder and Product Owner*

- Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware.
- Delivered setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required as the core enterprise-readiness USP.
- Served as deputy IT security officer.

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## § FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

### SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

*Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR*

- Full establishment of digital tooling, financial and investment planning, ERP introduction, and HR infrastructure for a deep-tech vertical farming startup across multiple founding roles.

### KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

*Founder and CFO*

- Built group-based P2P payments on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype. Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse.

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## § LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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